RetailzPOS / Moolah Points — Daily Trending Topics Brief

October 14, 2026

Trending now — 3 topics with a genuine brand angle

#	Trend	Source	Brand-twist content idea
1	**USDA's latest Food Price Outlook shows sharply uneven inflation by category** — beef and veal prices are projected up 7.5% in 2026 (the smallest U.S. cattle herd in roughly 75 years), while egg prices have actually dropped nearly 28% year-over-year; vegetables (+6.8%) and sugar/sweets (+7.2%) are rising faster than the overall grocery average of +2.8%.	AgBull — USDA Lowers 2026 Food Inflation Forecast But Prices Keep Climbing	**LinkedIn, margin-visibility post.** "Beef up 7.5%, eggs down almost 28% — 'prices are up' isn't specific enough to plan around anymore. The real question is which SKUs on your shelf are actually exposed and which ones aren't. Category-by-category visibility, not one blended number, is what actually answers that." Reinforces a theme we've raised before, now with sharper, more dramatic numbers.

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2	**Seasonal retail hiring is projected down 2.5% year-over-year** to about 450,000 Q4 jobs — continuing the smallest-gain trend since 2008 — with more retailers leaning on existing staff and on-demand pools instead of a big seasonal hiring wave this year.	Retail Dive — Holiday Seasonal Retail Hiring Lower	**Instagram/LinkedIn, ties directly to our Halloween staffing content.** "Seasonal hiring is down again this year — fewer stores are adding a big temp crew for the rush. That makes the nights we've already flagged (Halloween weekend, NYE) even sharper: if extra headcount isn't coming, the tools that take pressure off the staff you already have are doing more work than usual this season."
3	**Sweetest Day is this Saturday, October 17** — a real, if regional, candy-and-small-gifts occasion strongest in the Midwest, Northeast, Arizona, and Florida.	Wikipedia / aggregated calendar sources — Sweetest Day 2026	**Instagram, light merchandising post for convenience stores.** "Sweetest Day is this Saturday — an easy reason for a candy/snack end-cap refresh if the aisle hasn't moved since Halloween stock went up." Low-key, seasonal, no overclaiming on a holiday whose reach is real but regional.

Skipped, no genuine angle today: TikTok Shop's 2026 growth (no real fit for age-restricted, physical-location retail — it's built around shippable DTC product sales), and alcohol-delivery law news (nothing confirmed dated to October 2026; the most relevant lead, Oregon's OLCC delivery study, has an unclear release status).

Compliance check: none of the above imply pricing, encourage overconsumption, or use underage-adjacent framing — #1 is category-level cost data, #2 reinforces an already-published staffing/compliance theme, #3 is a neutral, non-alcoholic merchandising note.